026. Al-Shu'araa ~ The Poet

227 Ayaat (Makki)

FOCUS

NO MIRACLE WILL CONVINCE THOSE WHO WISH TO COVER UP THE TRUTH TO BELIEVE
STORIES OF PREVIOUS PROPHETS DEMONSTRATING SIMILAR CHALLENGES
AND FUNDAMENTAL TEACHINGS
THE QUR'AN - A REVELATION FROM DIVINITY TO THE HEART OF THE PROPHET

DID YOU KNOW?

ONE OF THE THREE CHAPTERS THAT BEGIN WITH 'TAA SEEN MEEM'. LARGEST NUMBER OF AYAAT IN A MAKKI SURA
THE CHAPTER TAKES ITS NAME FROM VERSE 224-227 WHICH PORTRAYS POETS WHO WERE THE PHILOSOPHICAL LEADERS OF THE QURAYSH AND REGARDED AS HIGHLY EDUCATED ENTERTAINERS WITH NO DIRECTION
THE STYLE OF THE CHAPTER IS OF A RHYTHMIC AND POETIC NATURE

SELECTED AYAAT

26:47	Magicians of Pharaoh submit
26:78-82	Prophet Ibrahim's (pbuh) description of Allah
26:89	Qalbe Saleem
26:195	Arabic
26:214	Warning the nearest relations
26:224	Poets

NARRATIVE

THE CHAPTER BEGINS WITH TELLING THE PROPHET THAT REGARDLESS OF WHAT IS REVEALED, THOSEE WHO ARE ADAMANT IN COVERING UP THE TRUTH WILL NOT BELIEVE.
MUCH OF THE REST OF THE CHAPTER RECOUNTS THE STORIES OF PREVIOUS PROPHETS WHO FACED SIMILAR CHALLENGES WITH THE SAME TEACHINGS. IT BEGINS WITH THE ACCOUNT OF PROPHET MUSA'S CONFRONTATION WITH FIRAWN, HIS CONTEST WITH THE MAGICIANS AND THEIR SUBSEQUENT SUBMISSION TO HIS LEAVING EGYPT WITH THE BANI ISRAAIL. THIS IS FOLLOWED BY AN ACCOUNT OF PROPHET IBRAHEEM AND THE DEBATE WITH HIS PEOPLE ABOUT IDOLS AND THEN HIS AWESOME DESCRIPTION OF ALLAH AND ASKING FOR FORGIVENESS, WISDOM, TRUTH AND JANNA. NEXT IS THE STORY OF PROPHET NUH AND HIS PEOPLE'S AVERSION TO A PERSON WHOM THE LOWER CLASS FOLLOWED. THIS IS FOLLOWED BY PROPHET HUD WHOSE PEOPLE ARE CONDEMNED FOR THEIR ARROGANCE OVER WORLDLY POSSESSIONS AND PROPHET SAALIH WHOSE PEOPLE ARE CHARACTERISED BY THEIR MATERIAL ATTACHMENT. FINALLY THERE ARE ACCOUNTS OF PROPHETS LUT AND SHUAYB.
THE CHAPTER AFFIRMS THAT THE QUR'AN WAS REVEALED TO THE HEART OF THE PROPHET IN ARABIC AND THE FIRST GROUP TO BE WARNED WERE THE PROPHETS NEAR RELATIONS. IT CONTINUES TO DESCRIBE THOSE ON WHOM SHAYTAAN DESCENDS AND CONCLUDES BY SAYING THAT THE POETS WHOM THE PRE ISLAMIC ARABS REVERED PORTRAYED A FALSE REPRESENTATION OF REALITY.